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Java developer (Microservices)

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Interview Experience

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Questions**



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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Scenario :

You have a payment processing microservice built using Java + Spring Boot that calls three downstream services:

- Account Service
- Fraud Detection Service
- Notification Service

During peak traffic, the Fraud service becomes slow and starts timing out.

Questions

- How will this impact the payment service?
- How would you design the system to prevent cascading failure?
- What patterns would you implement?
- How would you monitor and detect this issue in production?

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Your Spring Boot service suddenly stops responding during peak hours.

Monitoring shows:

- Database connections = maxed out
- Threads waiting for connections

Questions

- What could cause this issue?
- How would you diagnose it?
- How would you configure connection pools (HikariCP)?
- What coding mistakes can exhaust DB connections?

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Your system uses Kafka for event-driven processing.
Sometimes duplicate events are processed.

Questions

- Why does Kafka deliver duplicates?
- How would you design the consumer to be idempotent?
- What strategies ensure exactly-once processing?

A microservice uses @Async methods heavily.

During production:

- CPU usage is low
- Requests are still slow

Questions

- What could be wrong with thread pool configuration?
- How do you tune thread pools?
- Difference between FixedThreadPool vs
CachedThreadPool?

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

A loan approval system has 5 steps:

1. Credit score check
2. Risk evaluation
3. Loan approval
4. Ledger update
5. Notification

Step 4 fails.

Questions

- How would you handle partial failure?
- Would you rollback everything?
- How would you design a compensation workflow?

Each service call takes 50ms, but the overall request takes 3 seconds.

Questions

- What architectural issues could cause this?
- How would you identify the bottleneck?

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Your application shows:

- GC pauses: 5–10 seconds
- CPU spikes

Questions

- How would you tune JVM?
- Which GC algorithms exist?
- How would you analyze GC logs?

Two requests arrive simultaneously:

- Withdraw ₹10,000
- Check balance

Both hit the service at the same time.

Questions

- What race conditions can occur?
- How would you guarantee correct balance visibility?
- Would you solve it at:
 - Application layer
 - Database layer
 - Messaging layer?

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Your Kafka consumer lag increases rapidly.

Producer rate = 1000 messages/sec

Consumer rate = 300 messages/sec

Questions

- What could cause the lag?
- How would you scale the consumer?
- What happens if Kafka partitions are limited?

An API receives 10MB JSON payloads.

Memory usage spikes.

Questions

- How would you handle large payloads efficiently?
- Would you use streaming or chunking?

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

During rolling deployment:

- Old version and new version run together
- APIs start failing

Questions

- What compatibility issues can cause this?
- How would you design APIs to prevent it?

Your service suddenly receives 10x traffic due to a partner bug.

Questions

- What protections should exist?
- How would you avoid service crash?

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Your system maintains account balances in a database and transaction events in Kafka.

A bug causes balance mismatch between DB and event stream.

Questions

- How would you detect the inconsistency?
- How would you reconcile the balances?
- How would you design the system to prevent this in the future?

Your application uses a fixed thread pool of 20 threads.

Some requests take 30 seconds.

Eventually all threads get blocked.

Questions

- What problem is this?
- How would you solve it?

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